UNIT 3 – FUNDAMENTALS OF WEB DIGITAL MEDIA DESIGN

ACTIVITY 3 – RESEARCH AND DESIGN PRINCIPLES AUDIT

Name:		**Year & Section:**	
Subject:		**Date:**	

A. ACTIVITY OVERVIEW

This activity is a self-directed learning task designed to help you understand and apply fundamental design principles used in web and digital media design. Because this lesson is completed asynchronously, you will first research the principles using reliable references, then apply what you learned by auditing an actual website or digital media layout. The goal is not simply to define the terms, but to explain how design decisions affect communication, readability, visual appeal, and user experience.

B. LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Explain the basic principles of design using your own words.
- Identify how design principles are used in websites and digital media layouts.
- Support research findings with credible references.
- Analyze an actual digital media layout using appropriate design terminology.
- Evaluate the effectiveness of a design and recommend realistic improvements.

C. PART 1 – RESEARCH THE DESIGN PRINCIPLES

Before analyzing a design, research the eight principles below. Use reliable sources such as university learning resources, Adobe, Figma, design textbooks, educational websites, or other credible references. Do not copy definitions word-for-word. Read, understand, and explain each principle in your own words. Include at least one source/reference for every principle.

Design Principle	Definition in Your Own Words	Example in Web/Digital Media	Source / Reference
1. Balance			
2. Contrast			
3. Alignment			
4. Proximity			
5. Repetition			
6. Visual Hierarchy			
7. White Space			
8. Consistency			

Suggested starting references: University design-learning resources, Adobe Learn, Figma Resource Library, and other credible educational sources. Always cite the specific page/resource you used.

D. PART 2 – DESIGN PRINCIPLES AUDIT

Choose ONE real website, social media page, online advertisement, digital poster, landing page, or other digital media layout. Take or attach a screenshot of the design you analyzed. Then use your research from Part 1 to complete the audit below.

- Choose a design that contains enough visual elements to analyze.
- Identify at least SIX of the eight principles. If a principle is not clearly present, explain why.
- Do not simply say “present” or “not present.” Point to a specific element in the design and explain its effect.
- Use your own observations and connect them to the concepts you researched.

Principle	Evidence in the Selected Design	How It Is Applied	Effect on Audience/User	Improvement (if needed)
1. Balance				
2. Contrast				
3. Alignment				
4. Proximity				
5. Repetition				
6. Visual Hierarchy				
7. White Space				
8. Consistency				

E. PART 3 – OVERALL DESIGN EVALUATION

1. What is the main purpose of the design you selected?

Answer: _____

_____

2. Who appears to be the intended audience?

Answer: _____

_____

3. What design principle is used most effectively? Explain why.

Answer: _____

_____

4. What design problem or weakness did you notice?

Answer: _____

_____

5. If you were the designer, what TWO changes would you make to improve the design?

Answer: _____

_____

6. How do the design principles help the digital media communicate its message more effectively?

Answer: _____

_____

F. PART 4 – SHORT REFLECTION

In 7–10 sentences, answer: “How did researching the design principles change the way you look at websites and digital media designs?” Your reflection should show what you learned and how you can apply it to your future digital media projects.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

G. REQUIRED OUTPUT

1. Completed Design Principles Research Table (8 principles)
2. Screenshot/image of the selected digital media design
3. Completed Design Principles Audit (at least 6 principles)
4. Overall Design Evaluation
5. 7–10 sentence Reflection
6. List of references/sources used

H. SUBMISSION REMINDER

Submit your work in the format required by your instructor. Make sure your name, year & section, screenshot, answers, and references are complete. Use your own words. Properly acknowledge the sources you used.

I. RUBRIC – 40 POINTS

Criteria	Excellent	Developing	Points
Research & Understanding	Accurate, clear, own-word explanations with credible references	Definitions are incomplete, unclear, or weakly supported	10
Design Principles Audit	Specific evidence and thoughtful application of at least 6 principles	Mostly descriptive; limited evidence or application	12

Design Evaluation	Strong connection to purpose, audience, usability, and improvement	General evaluation with limited justification	8
Reflection	Insightful reflection showing learning and future application	Mostly summary; limited personal insight	5
Organization & References	Complete, organized, readable, and properly acknowledges sources	Some missing/unclear parts or references	5

TOTAL: 40 POINTS